

Role Guide 4: Questionnaire QA Research Assistant

Step-by-step instructions for the QUAN/Kobo QA RA role in the ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal.

STUDY	Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)
PRINCIPAL RESEARCHER	Happyson Saina, Doctor of Strategic Management candidate, Chinhoyi University of Technology
SUPERVISORS	Dr L. Chikazhe and Dr J. Kanyepe
FOR	Research assistants who check the quality of questionnaire submissions
SYSTEM ADDRESS	https://research.agribizframework.com
CONTACT	0773943709 · abffst.research.cut@gmail.com
VERSION	Version 1.5 · 20 September 2026

Screenshots in this document use **fictional demonstration data**. Organisation and person names, phone numbers and figures shown in them are not real study records.

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1. Your role at a glance

You make sure every questionnaire counted towards the 400 target is complete, plausible and genuine. The system checks each submission automatically, but nothing passes QA until you (or the Field Coordinator or PI) decide, with a note.

You can

- See the QA Dashboard, QA Queue and QA Exceptions.
- Accept, re-query or reject submissions with a note.
- Assign, work and close QA exceptions.
- Run a KoboToolbox sync.
- Download and email PDFs of completed questionnaires.

You cannot

- See names, contact details or case pages; KII or document records; dashboards other than QA; exports.
- Change answers — corrections are made in KoboToolbox by whoever administered the questionnaire.
- Pass a submission without a note.

Where this fits

The System Manual explains how the whole system works. This guide covers only what you do. Ask the Field Coordinator or PI when something is outside your role.

2. Signing in and your screens

Signing in

1. Open <https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login> in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari), on a computer, tablet or phone.
2. Type your **Username** and **Password**, then select **Sign in**.

The image shows a web browser window displaying the internal sign-in page. At the top, a dark blue header bar contains the text 'CHINHOMI UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY' and 'ABF-FST Research Operations Centre'. Below the header, the main content area is light gray. In the center, there is a white box titled 'Internal sign in'. Inside this box, there are two input fields: 'Username' with the text 'pi.admin' and 'Password' which is empty. Below the password field is a dark blue button labeled 'Sign in'.

Figure 1. The sign-in screen for all internal staff.

3. You arrive on your start screen: **QA Dashboard**. The bar across the top lists only the screens your role (QUAN/Kobo QA RA) can open.

Accounts

There is no self-registration. The PI / System Admin creates every account and sets its role. Ask the PI if you need an account, a different role, or a password reset.

Finding your way around

- The **top bar** shows your username and role, and the screens you can use. It is not a full menu with some items greyed out: anything absent is simply not part of your role.
- Most screens have a **← Back to ...** link at the top that returns you to the screen you came from.
- Registers show **20 rows per page**. Use **Previous** and **Next** at the foot of the list, and the **Search** box above it.
- **Change password** (top right) lets you set a new password at any time. Choose a long password you do not use anywhere else.
- **Sign out** (top right) ends your session. Always sign out on a shared or public computer.
- If you are inactive for a while you may be asked to sign in again. This protects research data on unattended devices.



Figure 2. Opening a screen outside your role (for example from an old bookmark) shows this card instead of the screen.

Your screens

Screen	What you use it for
QA Dashboard	Submissions today and in total, queue size, decisions, modes.
Form PDFs	Readable copies of completed questionnaires.
QA Queue	Take decisions; run a KoboToolbox sync.
QA Exceptions	Automated flags to investigate and close.

Changing your password

1. Select **Change password** in the top right corner.
2. Enter your **Current password**, then the **New password** twice, and select **Change password**.



Figure 3. Change Password screen.

3. Use the new password next time you sign in. If you have forgotten your password, ask the PI to reset it.

3. Your routine

A suggested rhythm. Adjust it to the Field Coordinator's plan.

When	What to do
Start of day	QA Dashboard: how many are waiting. Sync now on the QA Queue if you expect new submissions.
Main work	Oldest QA exceptions first, then the QA Queue oldest first.
For each submission	Open the PDF, check the rules, decide with a clear note.
End of day	Queue and exceptions no older than two days; report patterns (e.g. many short completions from one mode) to the Field Coordinator.

4. Step-by-step tasks

4.1 Reading the QA Dashboard

1. Select **QA Dashboard**. It shows submissions today and cumulatively, the open queue, decisions recorded, and completions by administration mode (01–06).

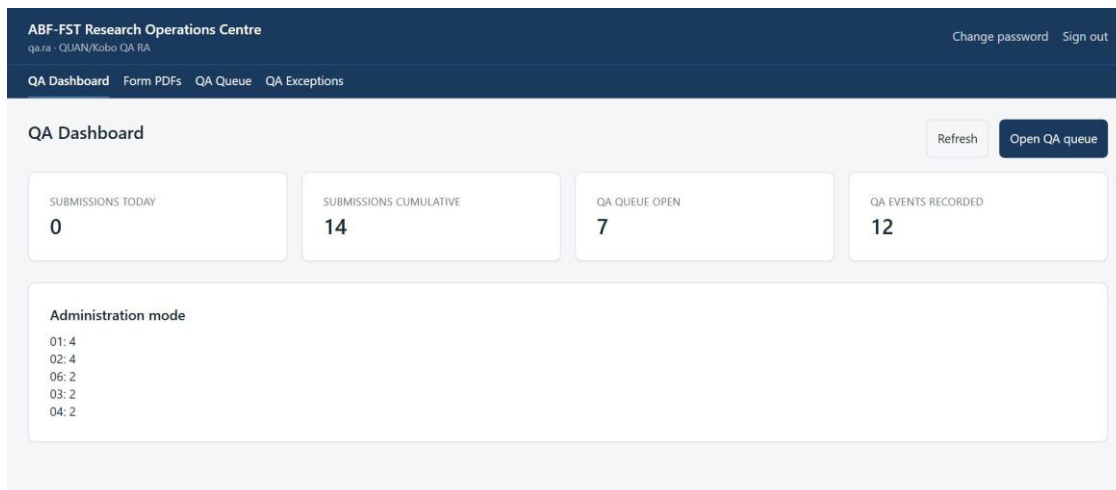


Figure 4. QA Dashboard.

2. Select **Refresh** to update the figures, or **Open QA queue** to start work.

4.2 Reviewing questionnaires in the QA Queue

1. Select **QA Queue**. Each submission shows the Sample ID, when it was submitted, the administration mode, the completion time in minutes and its QA status (PENDING or QUERY).

The QUAN QA Queue interface displays the following information:

Back to QA Dashboard

QUAN QA Queue

KoboToolbox sync [Sync now]

Last synced 9/15/2026, 7:03:04 PM (schedule) -- 14 pulled, 1 new, 0 updated.

SID-2026-000063 [PENDING]
Submitted 8/26/2026, 6:15:00 PM · Mode 06 · 32 min

Note (required)

Accept Re-query Reject

A note is required before recording a decision.

SID-2026-000057 [PENDING]
Submitted 8/31/2026, 8:15:00 PM · Mode 02 · 3 min

Note (required)

Accept Re-query Reject

Figure 5. QUAN QA Queue with the KoboToolbox sync panel.

2. Open the completed form to check the answers: **Form PDFs → Download PDF**, or the **Completed questionnaire** panel on the case page.
3. Check it against the QA rules (table below) and any open QA exception for that case.
4. Write a **Note (required)** explaining your decision.
5. Select **Accept** (moves the case to S10 QA passed), **Re-query** (S09 QA query — follow up with the respondent or the RA who administered it) or **Reject** (not usable).

Rule	Setting	Effect
Required answers missing	65 required fields from the live questionnaire	Hard stop: raises an exception; cannot pass without a human decision and note.
Too quick	Completed in under 5 minutes (300 s)	Soft flag for review.
Too slow	Completed in over 90 minutes (5400 s)	Soft flag for review.
Possible duplicate	Another submission for the same organisation within 24 hours	Soft flag for review.

Nothing passes automatically

Even a submission with no flags needs a person to select Accept. Every decision and its note is audited.

Pulling new submissions now

Submissions arrive within seconds (KoboToolbox notifies the portal) and a full check runs every 15 minutes between 06:00 and 22:00 and hourly overnight. To check immediately, select **Sync now** in **KoboToolbox sync**; the panel shows the last run, how many were pulled and how many were new or updated. An edited submission returns to the queue for review.

4.3 Working QA exceptions

1. Select **QA Exceptions**. Each card shows the rule that fired (for example `hard_stop_missing_required_fields` or `min_plausible_duration_seconds`), the Sample ID, when it was raised and its status. Oldest first.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
qa.ra - QUAN/Kobo QA RA

Change password Sign out

QA Dashboard Form PDFs QA Queue QA Exceptions

Back to QA Queue

QA Exception Queue
Automated QA flags awaiting someone. Oldest first.

☐ Only mine ☐ Show closed

OPEN ON THIS PAGE
1

IN PROGRESS
2

OLDEST HERE
today

min_plausible_duration_seconds
QUAN submission SID-2026-000057 - raised 9/15/2026

Unassigned

What was done about it? (required to close)

Resolved Not a real problem

A note is required before closing — a closure nobody explained looks the same as one nobody looked at.

hard_stop_missing_required_fields
QUAN submission SID-2026-000065 - raised 9/15/2026

qa.ra with qa.ra

Figure 6. QA Exception Queue.

1. Tick **Only mine** to see exceptions assigned to you; tick **Show closed** to include resolved ones.
2. Use **Assign to** to take ownership (or give it to a colleague). The status becomes **In progress**.
3. Investigate: open the form PDF, check the case timeline, contact the respondent if needed.
4. Type **What was done about it?** and select **Resolved**, or **Not a real problem** if the flag was a false alarm. A note is always required.

4.4 Downloading or emailing completed forms (Form PDFs)

1. Select **Form PDFs**. You see the completed questionnaire forms from KoboToolbox, newest first, 20 per page.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
qa.ra - QUAN/Kobo QA RA

Change password Sign out

QA Dashboard Form PDFs QA Queue QA Exceptions

Back to QA Dashboard

Completed forms

✓ In sync with KoboToolbox
KoboToolbox holds 3 - the portal holds 3 - last synced 9/20/2026, 1:05:25 AM

Sync now

SID-2026-000069 ✓ saved in portal
Submitted 9/14/2026, 6:12:40 AM - web form

Download PDF Email to me Email to respondent

SID-2026-000071 ✓ saved in portal
Submitted 9/13/2026, 12:40:02 PM - web form

Download PDF Email to me Email to respondent

SID-2026-000073 ✓ saved in portal
Submitted 9/12/2026, 8:05:57 AM - web form

Download PDF Email to me Email to respondent

Showing 1-3 of 3 submissions

Previous Page 1 of 1 Next

Figure 7. Completed form PDFs.

2. Select **Download PDF** to save a readable copy: sections, questions, the chosen answers as words (not codes) and repeated groups.
3. Select **Email to me** to send the PDF to the email address on your account.
4. For the questionnaire only, select **Email to respondent** to send the respondent a copy of their own answers at the email address recorded on the case (only while their consent stands). You are asked to confirm first. Every email is audited with the address masked.

At the top of the page, a sync panel shows whether the portal holds the same forms as KoboToolbox, for example “✓ In sync with KoboToolbox — KoboToolbox holds 12 · the portal holds 12”. Each row also says “✓ saved in portal” once the portal has an identical copy. If the panel says “Not in sync”, select **Sync now** (read-only roles see the panel but not the button); it takes a few seconds.

The same PDF is available from the record itself: the case page (questionnaire), the KII page (KII Guide) or the document page (coding form).

How the sync works

The portal keeps its own copy of the questionnaire, KII Guide and Document Analysis Tool, and refreshes it every 15 minutes and whenever someone selects Sync now. A submission edited in KoboToolbox is updated here; one deleted in KoboToolbox is flagged as removed. You never need to sync before downloading a PDF: the PDF is always read from KoboToolbox at that moment.

4.5 Writing good QA notes

- State what you checked and what you found: "Duration 3 min; answers straight-lined in Sections 4–6; re-queried with RA".
- For Accept: "All required answers present; duration 28 min plausible; no duplicate".
- For Re-query: say exactly what needs confirming or completing.
- Never include personal opinions about the respondent.

5. Rules you must follow

- Decide on evidence, not on who the organisation is.
- Never download PDFs to personal devices or share them outside the team.
- Treat everything in the portal as **confidential research data**. Do not screenshot, copy, print or forward names, phone numbers, email addresses or answers except as your role requires.
- Never share your username or password, and never sign in for someone else.
- Use the respondent's contact details **only** to manage their participation in this study (invitations, reminders, appointments).
- Never tell a respondent, lender or anyone else that answers affect financing. The study generates **no score, rating or financing decision**.
- If a respondent asks to withdraw, stop contacting them and tell the Field Coordinator or PI the same day so the withdrawal is recorded.
- Report a lost device, a suspected account compromise, or data sent to the wrong person to the PI immediately.

6. Troubleshooting

Situation	Likely cause	What to do
Accept / Re-query / Reject are greyed out	No note written yet.	Type the note first.
A submission I expected is not in the queue	It has not been pulled yet, or it was set aside (not launched from the portal).	Select Sync now; if still missing, tell the Field Coordinator.
"This screen isn't part of your role"	The screen belongs to another role (often an old bookmark or shared link).	Select Go to my start screen. If you need that screen, ask the PI about your role.
"Too many sign-in attempts from this network"	Sign-in is rate-limited per network; an office shares one address.	Wait a minute and try again. A wrong password says so explicitly.
A register shows fewer rows than expected	Registers show 20 rows per page; a Contact RA sees only assigned cases.	Use Next, or search. Ask the Field Coordinator to assign the case.
A button is greyed out	A required step is missing (a note, an authenticity decision, a selection).	Read the message beside the button; complete the missing step first.
"KoboToolbox couldn't be reached"	KoboToolbox is slow or the connection token has changed.	Try again in a few minutes. If it persists, tell the PI.
Form PDFs says "Not in sync with KoboToolbox yet"	The counts differ: a form was submitted or changed in KoboToolbox since the last sync (it runs every 15 minutes).	Select Sync now. If it still differs, or says it couldn't reach KoboToolbox, try again in a few minutes and tell the PI if it persists.
A document says "Already submitted" and its answers are locked	Its coding was already sent to KoboToolbox; changing it here would not change that record.	To redo the coding, delete that record in KoboToolbox, then select Sync now on Form PDFs. The document unlocks.
A page keeps loading	A slow or dropped connection.	Refresh the page. Your saved work is not lost; unsaved typing may be.
A file upload seems stuck	A large file on a slow connection takes time; the bar shows how much has been sent.	Wait for Saving... and the file name. If it fails, try again or upload a smaller version.

7. Quick reference

Sign in	https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login
You start on	QA Dashboard
Duration limits	5 to 90 minutes
Duplicate window	24 hours
Required fields	65 from the live questionnaire
Help	Field Coordinator; PI: Happyson Saina, 0773943709, abffst.research.cut@gmail.com